Stress Relief

Five ways to breathe, all seated

NIMH lists relaxation and breathing as things people can try when they feel stressed. These five are lifeZoi examples. They are not a copied video and not a treatment for anxiety or for a breathing illness.

Sit in the posture you already use. Stop if you feel dizzy or short of breath. Trouble breathing needs urgent care, not another exercise.

- Ordinary breath: sit and breathe as you already do for about a minute.
- Counted breath: in for a comfortable count of 3, out for 3. Skip the count if it feels forced.
- Longer exhale: let the out-breath be a little longer if that is easy. Stop if you get lightheaded.
- Hand on the belly: rest a hand there and notice the breath. Do not force the belly out.
- One sigh: a slightly deeper breath in, a relaxed breath out, then return to ordinary breathing.

If the moment is heavy

A breathing idea is not a crisis plan. If you are in immediate distress in the United States, call or text 988. The Having a hard moment pages are short and nonjudgmental.

Educational only. lifeZoi does not diagnose, treat, or promise a result.
It does not promise a longer life.
Read it in lifeZoi: /library/guides/stress-relief